

monastery, played at church services, and composed; in 1865 he took minor orders as a Catholic abbé.

From 1869, Liszt divided his time between Rome and Weimar (where he gave piano master classes), while also helping to establish the conservatoire in Budapest (known today as the Liszt Academy). In his later years, he preferred to use the Hungarian version of his first name, Ferencz. The loneliness and declining health of old age often darkened his music, some of which developed a dissonant harmonic language that seems to gaze ahead toward the 20th-century Modernism of Bartók or Schoenberg. In 1886, Liszt was visiting the Wagner Festival at Bayreuth (which was run by Cosima after Wagner's death), when he died, leaving a vast musical legacy remarkable for its radicalism, much of which remains little known or performed, even today.



LISZT AND THE WAGNERS

Here, Liszt (seated, with gray hair) is shown with Richard Wagner (standing) and Cosima Wagner (Liszt's daughter and Wagner's wife), at the Wagners' house in Bayreuth, northern Bavaria, c. 1880.